

WORKFLOW DISCOVERY INSTRUMENT

Mission Product Workflow and Automation Assessment

Captures how a real product is created today: inputs, decisions, handoffs, waiting, rework, constraints, and the work that consumes the most time.

AUDIENCE	COMPLETION	PRIMARY OUTPUT
Analysts, planners, briefers, product creators	45-60 minutes per product	Current-state workflow + pilot candidate

Security and OPSEC: Complete this instrument only at the classification level of the system being used. Do not paste operational details, intelligence, PII, vulnerabilities, or sensitive source material into an unapproved environment. Use categories or sanitized examples when required.

How to complete: Use one recently completed product as the trace case. Describe what actually happened, including workarounds and rework—not only the official SOP. Complete a separate copy for each materially different product or workflow.

Respondent and product information

Unit / team [Enter]	Name or role [Enter]
Product name [Enter]	Date completed / trace case [Enter]

Typical suspense [Enter]	Typical frequency [Enter]
Primary consumer [Enter]	Interviewed by [Enter]

1. Product Purpose and Definition of Done

Anchor the workflow in the decision or action the product is meant to enable.

1.1 What decision, action, coordination, or shared understanding is this product supposed to enable?

[Type response here]

1.2 Who uses it? What does each audience member need from it?

[Type response here]

1.3 What makes the product 'done' and acceptable for release? Who decides?

[Type response here]

1.4 What changes between routine and surge production?

[Type response here]

1.5 Which parts are standard or reusable, and which must be newly reasoned or tailored every cycle?

[Type response here]

2. Trigger, Inputs, and Source Authority

Identify where work begins and which inputs can be trusted, accessed, and traced.

2.1 What triggers production: battle rhythm, tasking, new information, request, event, or commander / director direction?

[Type response here]

Input or source category	Authoritative?	Format	Where accessed	Sensitivity / access	Common quality issue
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Y/N/Conditional]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

2.2 Which inputs arrive late, incomplete, contradictory, duplicated, or in a format that is hard to use?

[Type response here]

2.3 How do you decide which source wins when sources disagree?

[Type response here]

2.4 What material is unavailable to some contributors because of permissions, systems, location, or classification?

[Type response here]

3. Current-State Workflow: What Actually Happens

Map the trace case from trigger to release. Include unofficial steps, shadow tools, and backtracking.

A. Production steps

Step	Action or decision	Role	Input / source	System or tool
1	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
2	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
3	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
4	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
5	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
6	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
7	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
8	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
9	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
10	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
11	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
12	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

3.1 Where does the actual workflow differ from the SOP, checklist, or published process?

[Type response here]

3.2 Which steps depend on one person's memory, relationships, tacit knowledge, or personal files?

[Type response here]

4. Time, Waiting, Handoffs, and Rework

Separate hands-on work from elapsed time. Waiting and revision loops often dominate the total cycle.

B. Step-level time and friction

Step	Hands-on min	Wait min	Handoff / approval	Rework or defect trigger	Frequency
1	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
2	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
3	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
4	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
5	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
6	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
7	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
8	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
9	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
10	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
11	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
12	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

Time measure	Routine cycle	Surge / short notice	How measured or estimated
End-to-end elapsed time	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Total hands-on production time	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Total waiting / queue time	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Typical number of revision rounds	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
People-hours across all contributors	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

4.1 Which three activities consume the most hands-on time? Estimate minutes or hours for each.

[Type response here]

4.2 Where does work sit idle, and what is usually being waited on?

[Type response here]

4.3 What late-breaking changes create the most rework?

[Type response here]

5. Friction and Failure Modes

Identify repeatable burdens and quality risks without assuming every pain point should be automated.

☐ Search across many repositories	☐ Copy / paste between systems
☐ Re-enter the same data	☐ Convert formats or reformat slides
☐ Manually extract facts or tables	☐ Reconcile conflicting versions
☐ Check freshness or source authority	☐ Chase inputs or approvals
☐ Merge contributions from many people	☐ Correct inconsistent terminology
☐ Build citations / source traceability	☐ Update recurring boilerplate
☐ Repair charts, maps, or visuals	☐ Respond to last-minute changes
☐ Manage classification / releasability	☐ Recover work during turnover or absence
☐ Brief from a product that is already stale	☐ Other: _____

Check every recurring friction. Then identify the top three below based on time, frequency, and mission consequence—not irritation alone.

Rank	Friction / failure mode	Frequency	Time cost	Mission / quality consequence	Current workaround
1	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
2	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
3	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

5.1 What errors are easiest to make and hardest to detect?

[Type response here]

5.2 What 'small' task is repeated so often that its total burden is large?

[Type response here]

6. Quality, Review, and Release

Make the control system visible: standards, checks, revisions, approvals, and accountability.

Quality dimension	How checked today	Who checks	Common defect	Release threshold
Accuracy / factual correctness	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Completeness	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Timeliness / freshness	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Consistency / terminology	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Source traceability	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Security / releasability	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Audience usefulness	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

6.1 Describe the review and approval path from first draft to release. Where do most comments enter?

[Type response here]

6.2 Which checks are rule-based and repeatable? Which require mission judgment?

[Type response here]

6.3 What evidence would help a reviewer trust an AI-assisted draft (for example: source links, change log, confidence, or validation results)?

[Type response here]

6.4 Who can release the product, and who is accountable if it is wrong?

[Type response here]

7. Human Judgment, Tacit Knowledge, and Boundaries

Protect the parts of the work that depend on intent, context, tradecraft, ethics, or accountable decision-making.

☐ Interpret commander / director intent	☐ Resolve ambiguity or conflicting evidence
☐ Assess operational relevance	☐ Adapt message to audience and context
☐ Make risk tradeoffs	☐ Recognize deception, anomaly, or missing context
☐ Exercise classification / releasability judgment	☐ Coordinate through trusted relationships
☐ Choose what not to include	☐ Recommend or make a mission decision

Check the judgment-intensive activities present in this workflow.

7.1 What do experienced creators know that is not written in the SOP or template?

[Type response here]

7.2 What contextual clues cause you to change the normal process, interpretation, or product structure?

[Type response here]

7.3 Which parts may be drafted or checked by automation but must always receive human review?

[Type response here]

7.4 Which parts should never be generated, decided, released, or transmitted by automation? Why?

[Type response here]

8. Technology, Access, and Working Conditions

Capture the environment in which the workflow must operate, including disconnected or constrained conditions.

System / tool / repository	Purpose	Approved environment	Access / permission issue	Integration or export limitation
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

8.1 Where must the workflow function: office, operations center, deployed, mobile, disconnected, or low-bandwidth?

[Type response here]

8.2 What tools are used unofficially because the approved workflow is too slow or incomplete? Describe the need, not sensitive tool details.

[Type response here]

8.3 What logs, permissions, version history, retention, or audit trail would an approved solution need?

[Type response here]

8.4 What training, support, or reliability level would be required before you would depend on it?

[Type response here]

9. Desired Future State and Pilot Candidate

Describe assistance that improves the work without removing necessary judgment or creating hidden burdens.

Workflow element	Keep human	Assist / augment	Automate if approved	Reason / condition
Find and retrieve inputs	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Extract and structure data	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Compare sources / identify changes	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Draft recurring sections	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Create slides / formatting	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Check completeness / consistency	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Route for review / track status	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]
Recommend or decide	☐	☐	☐	[Enter]

9.1 If one burden disappeared next month, which would create the most mission value?

[Type response here]

9.2 What is the smallest safe pilot that could test usefulness with real users and measurable evidence?

[Type response here]

9.3 What representative, sanitized, or approved sample set could be used for testing?

[Type response here]

9.4 What would make you stop using the solution, even if it saved time?

[Type response here]

9.5 What feedback method would make it easy to report errors, surprises, and improvement ideas?

[Type response here]

10. Evidence Package and Creator Summary

Identify the artifacts needed to validate the workflow and establish a baseline.

☐ Current template	☐ SOP / checklist
☐ One representative completed product	☐ Sanitized source inputs for that product
☐ Review comments or revision history	☐ Approval / release checklist
☐ Product schedule or battle rhythm	☐ Known defect or correction examples
☐ Access / system map	☐ Relevant policy or governance document

Do not transfer any artifact until the collection method and storage location are approved for its classification and sensitivity.

Creator summary	Response
The product matters because...	[Enter]
The most time is spent on...	[Enter]
The largest delay is caused by...	[Enter]
The most consequential quality risk is...	[Enter]
A safe first automation / augmentation opportunity is...	[Enter]
The human judgment that must be protected is...	[Enter]

11. Consultant Synthesis

Complete after observation, artifact review, and comparison across respondents. Do not treat a single interview as proof of the whole system.

Evidence category	Finding
Observed workflow evidence	[Enter]
Reported but not yet observed	[Enter]
Contradictions / variation across people	[Enter]
Primary bottleneck hypothesis	[Enter]
Primary quality / mission risk	[Enter]
Human judgment boundary	[Enter]
Candidate pilot and expected contribution	[Enter]
Evidence needed before recommendation	[Enter]

Baseline calculation

Measure	Current	Pilot target	Measurement method	Owner
End-to-end cycle time	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Hands-on production time	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Wait / queue time	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
Revision rounds / defect rate	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]
User confidence / usefulness	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]	[Enter]

Design basis: Lead Emergence evidence discipline; current-state workflow before solution design; role and capability mapping; human authorization; measurable value hypotheses; source authority, security, trust, readiness, governance, and consequence-aware AI adoption.